



▲ TRAINING FOR SPACE

Since the 1960s, NASA has used huge water tanks to mimic the weightlessness of space, mostly at the agency's Johnson Space Center in Texas.

1979

ESA debuts its Ariane 1 rocket, and soon becomes a major launch provider for the commercial satellite industry.

1992

Russia establishes Roskosmos, an agency that unites the many different design bureaus of the former Soviet space program.

2003

Japan's space agencies unite as the Japanese Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA). Other national space agencies exist in India (1969), Canada (1989), and China (1993).

2014

The Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO) reaches Mars on its first attempt, with its Mangalyaan space probe.